



Shrink it

A marker + a noun. The whole idea shrinks into a noun phrase.

idea 1

marker

noun

because of

WHY?

We stayed in **because of** the heat.**Because of** the heat, we stayed in.

Dá a razão. Depois vem só um nome: because of the heat.

due to · owing to

WHY? · FORMAL

The meeting moved **due to** the holiday.**Owing to** the roadworks, buses are slow.

Mesma razão, em tom mais escrito. Com sujeito e verbo, use because.

thanks to

GOOD REASON

Thanks to my aunt, I found a flat.I found a flat **thanks to** my aunt.

Dá uma razão boa, que trouxe um bom resultado.

despite · in spite of

EVEN SO?

We swam **despite** the cold water.She smiled **in spite of** the pain.

Contraste. Despite não leva "of"; in spite of leva.

during

WHEN?

I fell asleep **during** the lecture.

Diz quando aconteceu. Depois vem um nome de evento.

for

HOW LONG?

He waited **for** forty minutes.

Diz quanto tempo durou. Depois vem um período: for two hours.

ERRORS TO AVOID

Despite ~~of~~ the noise, she slept. · say: **Despite the noise, she slept.**~~In spite of~~ the noise, she slept. · say: **In spite of the noise, she slept.**We cancelled because of ~~it was windy~~. · say: **because it was windy.**We walked ~~during~~ three hours. · say: **We walked for three hours.**~~Thanks for~~ my teacher, I passed. · say: **Thanks to my teacher, I passed.**

QUICK RULES

Before a noun: because of · due to · thanks to · despite · in spite of · during.**Before subject + verb:** because · although · while (lesson 1).**Comma:** when the marker opens the sentence, the comma closes the noun.**Because of** the heat, we stayed in.**Tone:** because of in everyday talk · due to and owing to in writing.